Cover Letter

14 October 2026

Dear Editors of IEEE Access,

Please consider our manuscript, *Endpoint Definitions and Label Provenance in Honey-Bee Toxicity Benchmarking*, by Yongye Huang, Runqing Liao and Zhining Wang, as a Research Article.

The study examines how endpoint definitions and historical label-processing rules shape machine-learning evaluation on the ApisTox honey-bee toxicity benchmark. It compares three nested endpoints on the same 1,035 compounds and official splits, reconstructs all 441 ECOTOX-derived annotations, and separates qualifier handling from aggregation. A matched-member crossover then evaluates how identifiable provisional revisions affect the observed discrimination gaps. Source-supported provisional revisions did not consistently narrow the gap, separating confirmed annotation defects from their predictive consequences.

The contribution is a reproducible connection between source-record processing, benchmark labels and predictive evaluation. The analysis does not treat cross-source disagreement as a benchmark-wide error rate. The findings are relevant to chemical machine learning, computational toxicology and the construction of reliable scientific benchmarks.

The submission includes the manuscript, Supplementary Information, complete LaTeX sources, and Research Materials containing analysis code, input data, model outputs and source-record evidence. The study is a secondary computational analysis and involved no new animal experiments or human participants.

Thank you for considering this work.

Sincerely,
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